

Newcastle-Ottawa Quality Assessment Form for Cohort Studies

Note: A study can be given a maximum of one star for each numbered item within the Selection and Outcome categories. A maximum of two stars can be given for Comparability.

Selection

- 1) Representativeness of the exposed cohort
 - a) Truly representative **(one star)**
 - b) Somewhat representative **(one star)**
 - c) Selected group
 - d) No description of the derivation of the cohort
- 2) Selection of the non-exposed cohort
 - a) Drawn from the same community as the exposed cohort **(one star)**
 - b) Drawn from a different source
 - c) No description of the derivation of the non exposed cohort
- 3) Ascertainment of exposure
 - a) Secure record (e.g., surgical record) **(one star)**
 - b) Structured interview **(one star)**
 - c) Written self report
 - d) No description
 - e) Other
- 4) Demonstration that outcome of interest was not present at start of study
 - a) Yes **(one star)**
 - b) No

Comparability

- 1) Comparability of cohorts on the basis of the design or analysis controlled for confounders
 - a) The study controls for age, sex and marital status **(one star)**
 - b) Study controls for other factors (list) _____ **(one star)**
 - c) Cohorts are not comparable on the basis of the design or analysis controlled for confounders

Outcome

- 1) Assessment of outcome
 - a) Independent blind assessment **(one star)**
 - b) Record linkage **(one star)**
 - c) Self report
 - d) No description
 - e) Other
- 2) Was follow-up long enough for outcomes to occur
 - a) Yes **(one star)**
 - b) No

Indicate the median duration of follow-up and a brief rationale for the assessment above: _____

- 3) Adequacy of follow-up of cohorts
 - a) Complete follow up- all subject accounted for **(one star)**
 - b) Subjects lost to follow up unlikely to introduce bias- number lost less than or equal to 20% or description of those lost suggested no different from those followed. **(one star)**
 - c) Follow up rate less than 80% and no description of those lost
 - d) No statement

Thresholds for converting the Newcastle-Ottawa scales to AHRQ standards (good, fair, and poor):

Good quality: 3 or 4 stars in selection domain AND 1 or 2 stars in comparability domain AND 2 or 3 stars in outcome/exposure domain

Fair quality: 2 stars in selection domain AND 1 or 2 stars in comparability domain AND 2 or 3 stars in outcome/exposure domain

Poor quality: 0 or 1 star in selection domain OR 0 stars in comparability domain OR 0 or 1 stars in outcome/exposure domain